

August 12, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Keitha Turner (MRN MUSC0626052), Claim MUSC-20251123-6CD1-3

Patient	Keitha Turner (DOB 2004-07-22)
MRN	MUSC0626052
Member ID / Group	AMB999437436 / GRP-60820
Claim number	MUSC-20251123-6CD1-3
Date of service	2025-11-23
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$1,161.74
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-04-09

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of Keitha Turner (Member ID: AMB999437436) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20251123-6CD1-3 for services rendered on November 23, 2025, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. The claim was denied on January 9, 2026, under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying payer remark stating: "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment of the denied amount of \$1,161.74.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Turner is a 22-year-old established female patient with a documented history of recurrent acute upper respiratory infections, including multiple prior episodes of acute viral pharyngitis. Her medical history also includes a confirmed elevated shrimp IgE antibody level, an active epinephrine auto-injector prescription, and ongoing fexofenadine therapy, indicating a clinically complex allergic profile that has been actively managed over time through allergy screening and a sustained course of subcutaneous immunotherapy. On November 23, 2025, Ms. Turner presented to Dr. James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465) at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center for an established outpatient visit. The encounter was coded as CPT 99214, reflecting an office visit of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified).

BASIS FOR APPEAL

CPT code 99214 is appropriately assigned to an established patient visit requiring moderate medical decision-making. Given Ms. Turner's history of recurrent upper respiratory infections and her underlying allergic condition — including active prescriptions for both an antihistamine and an epinephrine auto-injector — evaluation and management of an acute upper respiratory infection in this patient reasonably involves a higher level of clinical judgment than a straightforward presentation would require. The treating physician's assessment of a patient with a known allergic background presenting with acute respiratory symptoms is consistent with the complexity level reflected in the 99214 code selection.

The payer's reliance on RARC N115, referencing a Local Coverage Determination, is noted; however, LCD-based denials are applicable primarily to Medicare fee-for-service claims. This claim was submitted under a Marketplace plan governed by the Ambetter from Absolute Total Care Advantage plan (Group GRP-60820), and the application of an LCD framework to a commercial Marketplace claim does not constitute a valid basis for denial under that plan's coverage terms. Furthermore, the denial does not identify any specific documentation deficiency beyond a general assertion that medical necessity was not established. MUSC Health maintains that the clinical record, including the patient's documented history and the complexity of her ongoing medical management, supports the medical necessity of this encounter.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care conduct a thorough clinical review of the complete medical record for the November 23, 2025 encounter, including Ms. Turner's documented history of recurrent upper respiratory infections and her active allergic condition management. We request that the denial be reversed in full and that payment be issued at the allowed amount of \$562.31, consistent with the plan's contracted rate. Should additional clinical documentation be required to complete this review, MUSC Health is prepared to submit it promptly through the secure provider portal in advance of the April 9, 2026 appeal deadline.

Respectfully submitted,

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record